

Skillet Broccoli-Cheddar Rice

Buttery rice, tender broccoli, and a broiled cheddar crust — all from one pan.

SERVES
4

PREP
10 min

COOK
35 min

DIFFICULTY
Easy

This has the DNA of a broccoli-rice casserole, but each element shines on its own: the rice is buttered and oniony-sweet, the broccoli stays tender and green (not mushy), and the cheddar is broiled on top for a mix of gooey and crisp bites. Eat it as-is, alongside rotisserie chicken or pork chops, or stir in a drained can of beans or tuna for a fuller meal.

Rice Base

Cooked together in one pan

Unsalted butter	2 tbsp
Yellow onion, finely chopped	1
Garlic cloves, thinly sliced	3
Long-grain white rice	1 cup
Water	1¾ cups
Salt	to taste

About 1 tsp Diamond Crystal kosher salt for the rice. Use an oven-safe skillet or Dutch oven with a lid.

Broccoli & Topping

Added in stages, broiled at the end

Broccoli stem, coarsely chopped	1 large head
Broccoli florets, 1-inch pieces	(same head)
Sharp cheddar, grated	4 oz (1 cup)
Hot sauce, for serving	optional

Directions

COOK THE RICE

- 1** Melt butter in a large Dutch oven or oven-safe skillet over medium heat. Add onion, garlic, and chopped broccoli stem. Season with salt and cook, stirring occasionally, until softened but not browned, 5–7 minutes.
- 2** Add rice and $1\frac{3}{4}$ cups water. Season with salt (about 1 tsp Diamond Crystal). Bring to a boil, cover, reduce heat to low, and simmer for 10 minutes.
- 3** Working quickly, scatter broccoli florets on top of the rice and season with a pinch of salt. Cover and cook until rice is tender and broccoli is bright green, 8–10 more minutes. Turn off heat and rest, covered, for 5 minutes.

BROIL & SERVE

- 1** Arrange a rack near the broiler and heat broiler to high.
- 2** Gently stir the broccoli and rice together, then sprinkle cheese evenly over the top.
- 3** Broil until melted and golden in spots, 2–4 minutes. Serve with hot sauce if desired.

Tips & Variations

- Don't skip the 5-minute covered rest — it lets the rice finish steaming and absorb any remaining water.
- Watch the broiler closely; cheese can go from golden to burned in under a minute. Keep the oven light on.
- For a heartier meal, stir in a drained can of white beans or tuna right before adding the cheese.

Nutrition information is not provided and will vary based on portion size and specific ingredients used. Consult a registered dietitian for guidance on your dietary needs.